

Picking a BaaS for your app

Why spend time and money building a backend when all these Backend-as-a-Service exist to make your life simpler?

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Building apps has become tremendously simple these days. To begin with, your SDK comes laden with a tonne of pre-built modules which you can simply drag and drop to create a functional prototype of your app within a matter of hours. However, that's just the application on your mobile which counts as the front end. Building a proper app with active services requires a backend as well and those don't come cheap. You can certainly build a backend just as easily but when you think of the level of reliability and uptime that's required to ensure that your users get the best possible experience, then you'd want to rely on professionals. Here's the deal breaker, good professionals don't come cheap either. By the time you're done building your backend, have all the communication subroutines in place and proceed to build the frontend, you'll probably be lacking in the "funds" department.

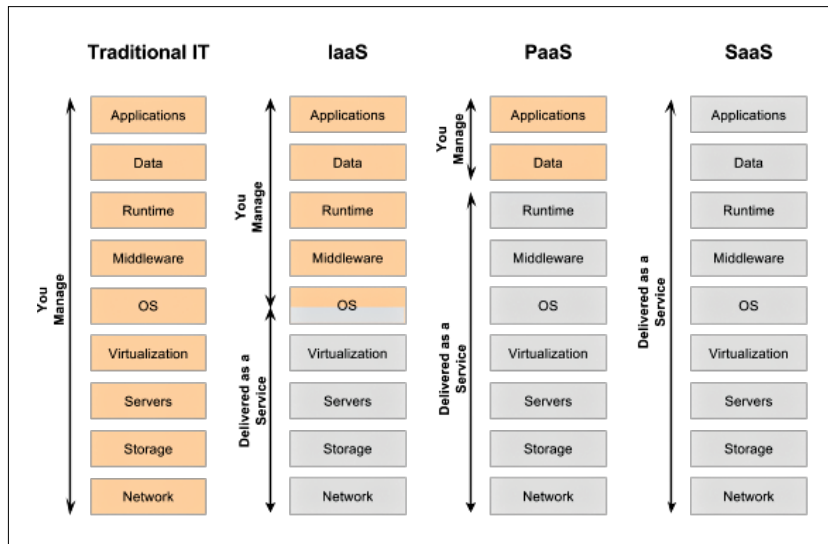
WHY WOULD YOU USE A BACK-END-AS-A-SERVICE?

While most popular apps have a custom backend solution that is best optimised for that app, they don't all start that way. Most folks tend to go with a backend-as-a-service or mobile-backend-as-a-service (Baas or mBaaS)

which provides a cloud backend that's easy to get started with and to manage. This way, you can be rid of all worries about the backend of your app and focus just on the frontend. Since most backends for applications run on some of the most popular services out there, it's very easy for folks to switch from one service to another and port all

comfortable using the services that are found with most BaaS. You no longer have to spend ridiculous man-hours and resources in training talent when talent already exists. Getting a developer to build your custom backend can cost anywhere from INR 10-15 lakhs for a small operation to over INR 1 Crore for applications with ample amount of traction. Then there's the cost of running a BaaS, which works out to be much cheaper than building everything from scratch.

Think of it in this manner, if you wanted to go at this from the ground up, then you'd buy an instance from a Cloud Service Provider such as AWS or Azure or Google Cloud. Then you'll have to figure out what platform you



Differences between IaaS, PaaS and BaaS

their information without breaking a sweat. Obviously, there are quite a few caveats to this approach but we're hoping that you're getting the message.

Aside from the convenience factor from a developer perspective there's also the business side of things that you should consider. When you have a standardised backend environment, you can easily get developers who are

want to build your backend on and then handle all the modules that will help you deploy and scale as per your needs. Each step that we've mentioned thus far requires human resources to actively manage them. On top of all that, you'd want to install your database, your authentication service, social integration, notifications, analytics and all the software that are associated